

Pardis Derakhshandeh

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Theoretical Formal Syntax · Morphosyntax · Argument Structure · Ergativity and Complex Alignment
Languages **Western Iranian languages:** Behbahani, Kurdish Varieties (Kurmanji, Sorani, Hawrami), Persian, and Southwestern Varieties (Dashti, Davani)
Historical: Old and Middle Persian: diachronic development of ergative alignment

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Linguistics 2021–Present
Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY
Dissertation: *The Architecture of Argument Licensing in Behbahani*
Committee: Francisco Ordóñez (Chair), Richard Larson, Faruk Akkuş (UMass Amherst)

M.A. in Linguistics 2018
University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran

B.A. in English Language and Literature 2015
University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran

NON-DEGREE SEEKING
Summer Program in Linguistics and Cognitive Science 2020
NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies

PUBLICATIONS AND CONFERENCE ABSTRACTS

Manuscripts in Preparation

- **Derakhshandeh, P.** *Split Alignment beyond Case in Behbahani*. Manuscript in preparation. (Draft available upon request).
- **Derakhshandeh, P.** *The Syntax–Morphology Interface in Behbahani: A Case Study of Stem Alternation*. Manuscript in preparation. (Draft available upon request).

Peer-reviewed Conference Abstracts

- **Derakhshandeh, P.** (2026). Beyond Tense: The Structural Autonomy of StemP in Behbahani. *The 50th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference (PLC 50) Handbook*.
- **Derakhshandeh, P.** (2025). Introducing Behbahani. *2025 LSA Annual Meeting Program*.

PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

- **2026.** *Beyond Tense: The Structural Autonomy of StemP in Behbahani*. Poster presented at the 50th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference (PLC 50), University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA.
- **2025.** *Introducing Behbahani*. Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, Philadelphia, PA.
- **2024.** *Split Alignment beyond Case*. Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY.
- **2023.** *Alignment in Behbahani*. Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, NY.

- **2018.** *Locus of the NegP in Behbahani*. University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran.
- **2017.** Speaker, “What is Linguistics?” Workshop for undergraduate students. University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran.
- **2016.** *A Study of Color Metaphors in Behbahani*. University of Kurdistan, Sanandaj, Iran.

RESEARCH PROJECT

- **Lead Organizer, “Introducing Behbahani to the Linguistics Community”** May–December 2024
 - Organized an LSA Annual Meeting session dedicated to linguistic research on Behbahani, a less-studied Iranian language.
 - Coordinated a team of colleagues and ten student presenters contributing analyses of Behbahani.
 - Mentored student researchers by providing linguistic data and refining research questions.
 - Guided the organization and analysis of linguistic data for conference presentations.
 - Provided detailed feedback on research design and presentation materials.

ORGANIZED SESSIONS AND EVENTS

- **LSA Organized Session:** “Linguists, Meet Behbahani: A Syntax, Morphology, Phonology, and Phonetics Data Blitz.” Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting (with Robert Hoberman and Daniel Greeson). January 2025.
- **Scholarly Seminar on Alice Munro** (Lead Organizer). Department of English Linguistics and Literature, University of Kurdistan. Sanandaj, Iran. November 2013.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stony Brook University - Primary Instructor

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| • LIN 200: Language in the United States | Winter 2026, 2024, 2023 |
| • LIN 541: Sociolinguistics | Summer 2025 |
| • LIN 541: Bilingualism | Summer 2024 |
| • PER 101: Intensive Elementary Persian | Summer 2022 |

Stony Brook University - Teaching Assistant

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| • LIN 200: Language in the United States | Spring 2026, Fall 2024 |
| • LIN 345 Writing Systems of the World <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Guest Lecturer: Delivered two specialized sessions on “Middle Eastern Writing Systems,” focusing on the evolution and structure of Persian and Kurdish orthographies. | Fall 2025 |
| • LIN 431: The Structure of an Uncommonly Taught Language: Behbahani <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Guest Lecturer & Consultant: Delivered the introductory lecture on the sociolinguistic background and typological features of Behbahani; provided ongoing linguistic consultancy for student fieldwork and data analysis. | Spring 2024 |
| • LIN 320: Structure of English Language | Fall 2023 |
| • LIN 340: Historical Linguistics | Spring 2023 |
| • LIN 307: Sociolinguistics | Fall 2022 |
| • LIN 431: The Structure of an Uncommonly Taught Language: Tati | Spring 2022 |
| • LIN 270: Language and Politics | fall 2021 |

Additional Teaching Assistant

The NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies

- Phonology Seminar: Strict CV Metrics or How to Live without Moras- Summer 2024
- Introduction to Syntax Winter 2024, Summer 2023
- Introduction to Syllable Structure Winter 2024
- Experimental Linguistics Winter 2022
- Semantics Seminar: Missing words and missing worlds winter 2022
- Linguistics field method Summer 2021
- Semantics Seminar: Three or Four Puzzles about Numerals Summer 2021

Additional Instruction

- English Language and Literature Instructor. Tavana high school, Behbahan, Iran. 2012-2021

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Regional Outreach and Recruitment Coordinator for Iran 2024 – Present
The NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies

- Lead student outreach and recruitment efforts in Iran, expanding access to international higher-education programs.
- Facilitate communication between prospective students and academic departments to streamline enrollment.

Staff Member, Student Accessibility Support Center (SASC) 2023 – 2025
Stony Brook University

- Support students with accessibility needs through academic assistance and secure exam proctoring.
- Ensure compliance with accommodation regulations and maintain a distraction-free testing environment.

Graduate Research Assistant Winter 2025
Stony Brook University

- **Collaborative Website Design for Tamil Research:** Developed a specialized website to showcase Tamil linguistic projects and facilitate global research collaboration.
- Integrated data resources to make the Tamil Research Group more accessible to the international linguistics community.

HONORS, AWARDS AND GRANTS

- **Research Fellowship**, Stony Brook University 2021
- **Travel Grant**, Department of Linguistics, Stony Brook University (for PLC 50) 2026
- **Travel Grant**, Department of Linguistics, Stony Brook University (for LSA) 2025
- **Travel Grant**, Department of Linguistics, Stony Brook University (for LSA) 2024
- **1st Place, Distinguished Student Award**, University of Kurdistan 2017
- **Ranked 35th (Top 1%)**, National M.A. Linguistics Exam (3,000 candidates) 2016
- **Best Student-Led Scientific Society Award**, University of Kurdistan 2014

SERVICE & OUTREACH

Stony Brook University

Departmental/ University

- **President**, Stony Brook Linguistics Club 2022–2024

Professional Service

- **Reviewer**, Stony Brook–Yale–NYU–CUNY (SYNC) Conference 2021, 2025

Outreach

- **Instructor**, North American Computational Linguistics Open Competition (NACLO) 2026
 - Prepared high school students for linguistic challenges by introducing formal patterns, structural analysis, and computational logic.

University of Kurdistan

- **Coordinator**, Departmental Colloquium on Linguistics and Cognitive Science 2012–2017
- **Coordinator**, Opening Ceremony of the Kurdish Studies Institute 2017
- **Executive Member**, Second National Conference on Reading 2017
- **Representative**, Linguistics Student Society 2016–2017

LANGUAGES

- **Native:** Behbahani, Persian
- **Advanced:** English, Sorani Kurdish
- **Heritage:** Lori
- **Fieldwork:** Ardalani Kurdish, Kalhori Kurdish, Southern Tati
- **Beginner:** Turkish

COMPUTING

- **Programming:**
 - **Proficient:** L^AT_EX, Git/GitHub
 - **Working Knowledge:** Python, R, Haskell, HTML
- **Experimental Tools:** Praat, ELAN, Qualtrics

Updated July 9, 2026